

Revision Record

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Course Code	Product	Product Version	Course Version
		V5R2	V1R1

Author/ID	Date	Reviewer/ID	New/ Update
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Inter-VLAN Communication



Foreword

- By default, a Layer 2 switching network is a broadcast domain, which brings many problems. Virtual local area network (VLAN) technology isolates such broadcast domains, preventing users in different VLANs from communicating with each other. However, such users sometimes need to communicate.
- This course describes how to implement inter-VLAN communication.



Objectives

- On completion of this course, you will be able to understand:
 - Methods of implementing inter-VLAN communication.
 - How to use routers (physical interfaces or sub-interfaces) to implement inter-VLAN communication.
 - How to use Layer 3 switches to implement inter-VLAN communication.
 - How Layer 3 packets are forwarded.



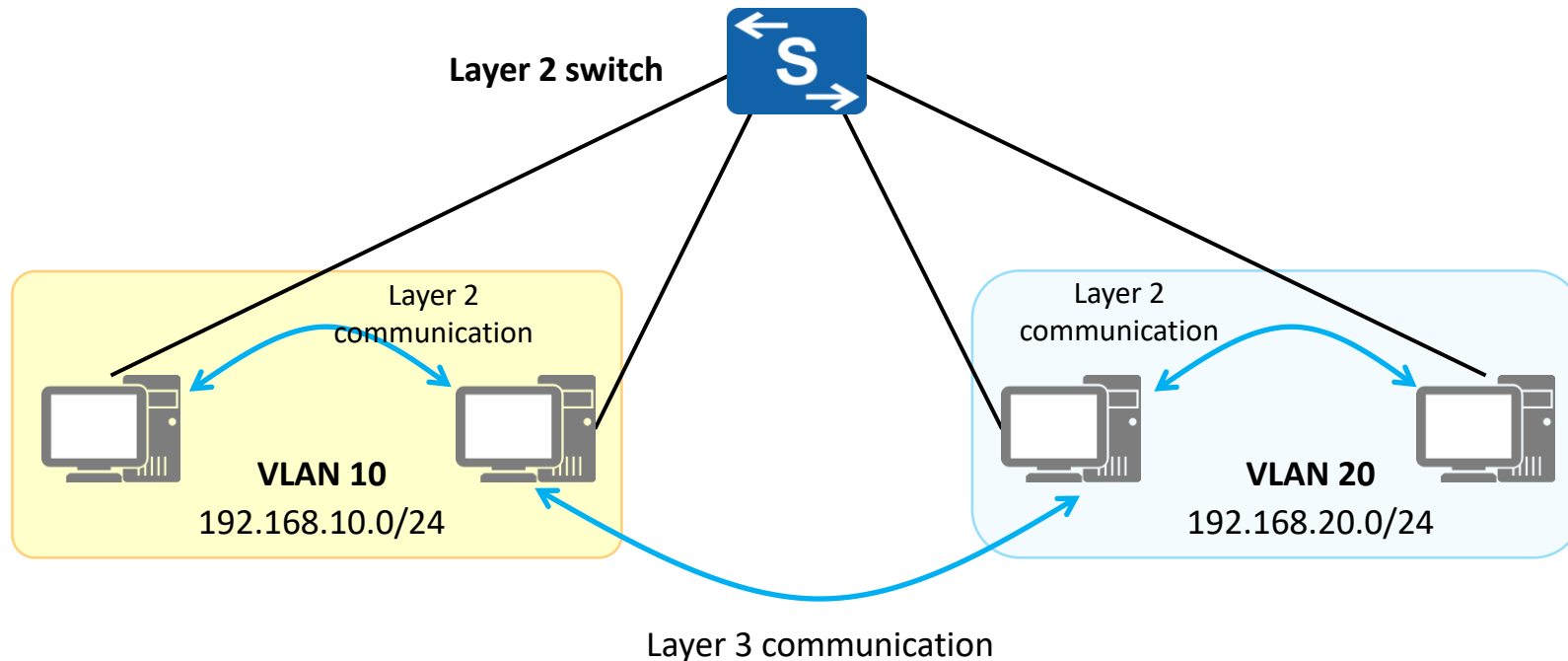
Contents

- 1. Background**
2. Using Routers' Physical Interfaces or Sub-interfaces to Implement Inter-VLAN Communication
3. Using VLANIF Interfaces to Implement Inter-VLAN Communication
4. Layer 3 Communication Process



Inter-VLAN Communication (1)

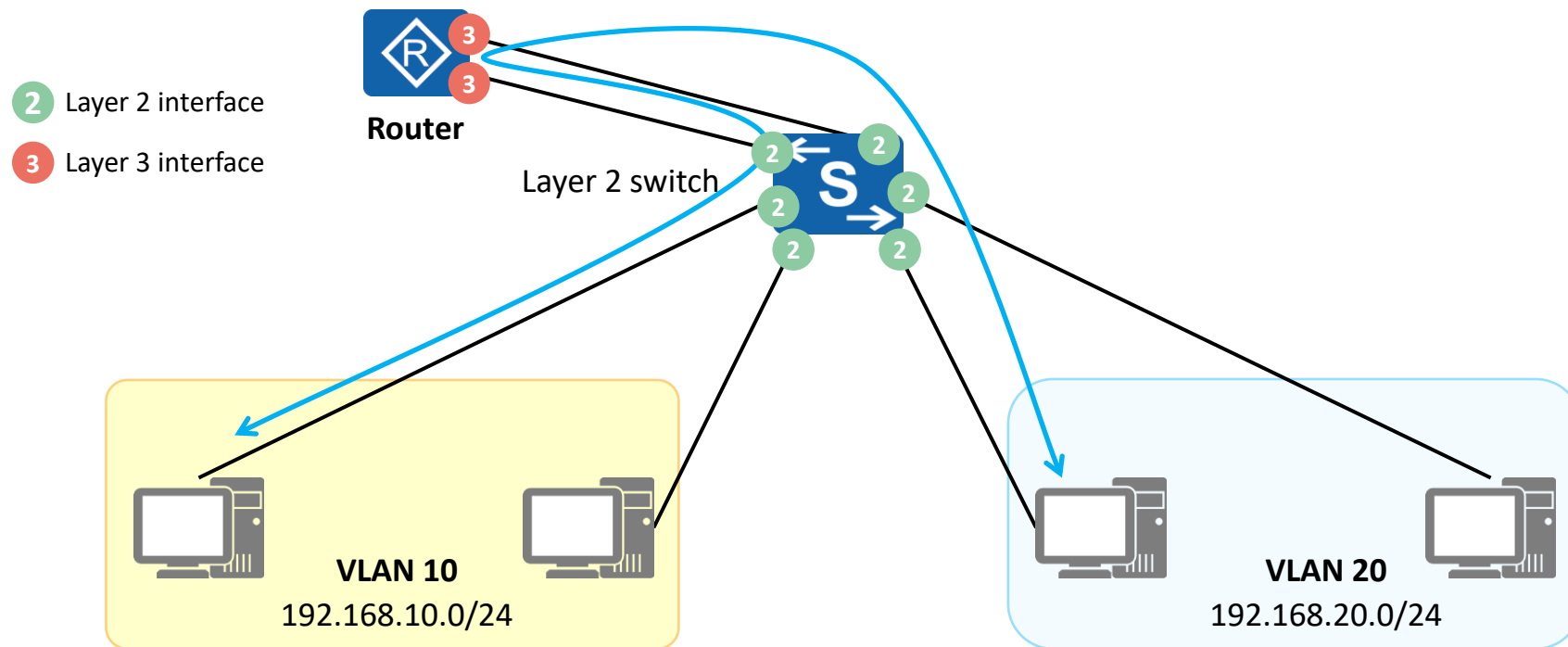
- In real-world network deployments, different IP address segments are assigned to different VLANs.
- PCs on the same network segment in the same VLAN can directly communicate with each other without the need for Layer 3 forwarding devices. This communication mode is called Layer 2 communication.
- Inter-VLAN communication belongs to Layer 3 communication, which requires Layer 3 devices.





Inter-VLAN Communication (2)

- Common Layer 3 devices: routers, Layer 3 switches, firewalls, etc.
- Inter-VLAN communication is implemented by connecting a Layer 2 switch to a Layer 3 interface of a Layer 3 device. The communication packets are routed by the Layer 3 device.





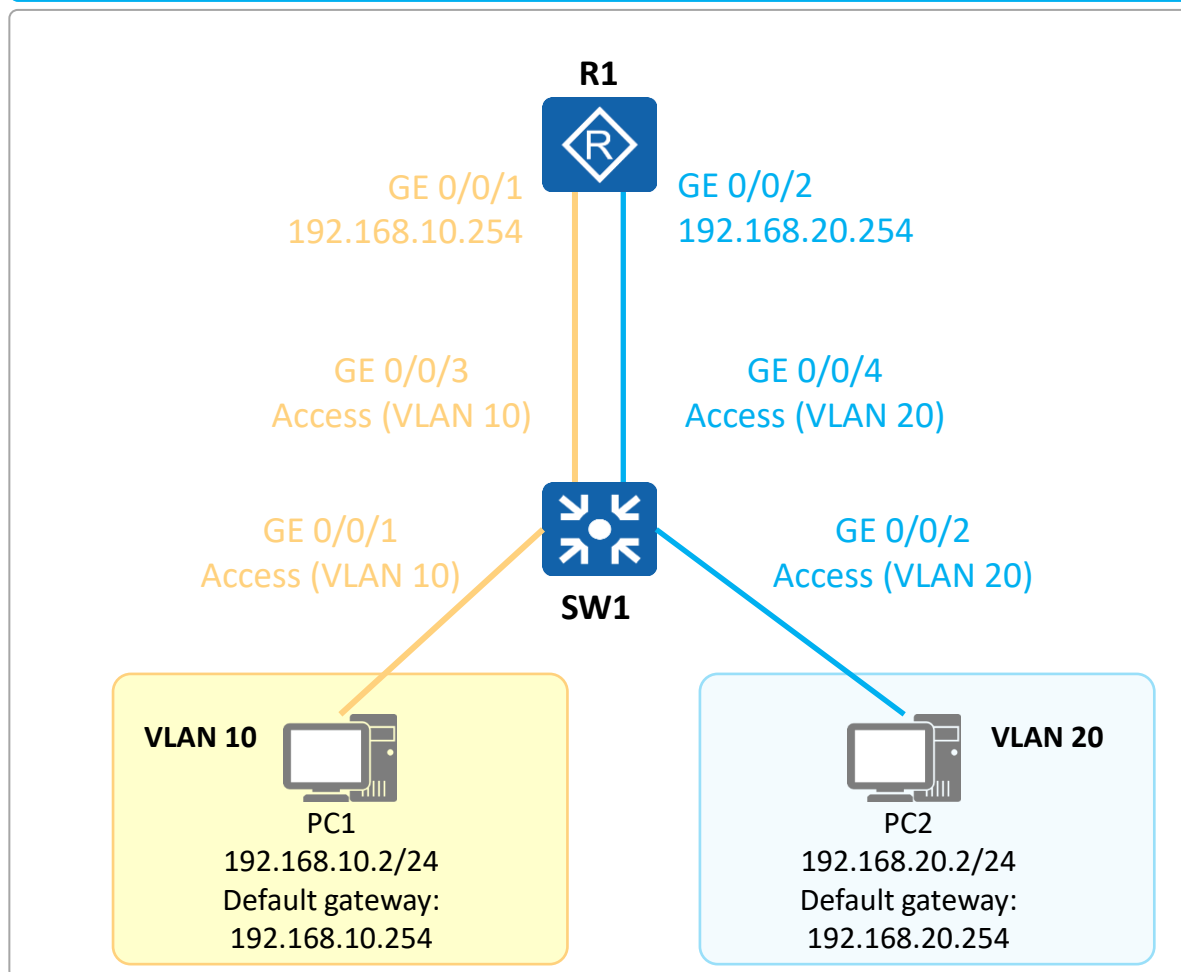
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Using a Router's Physical Interfaces

Physical Connection

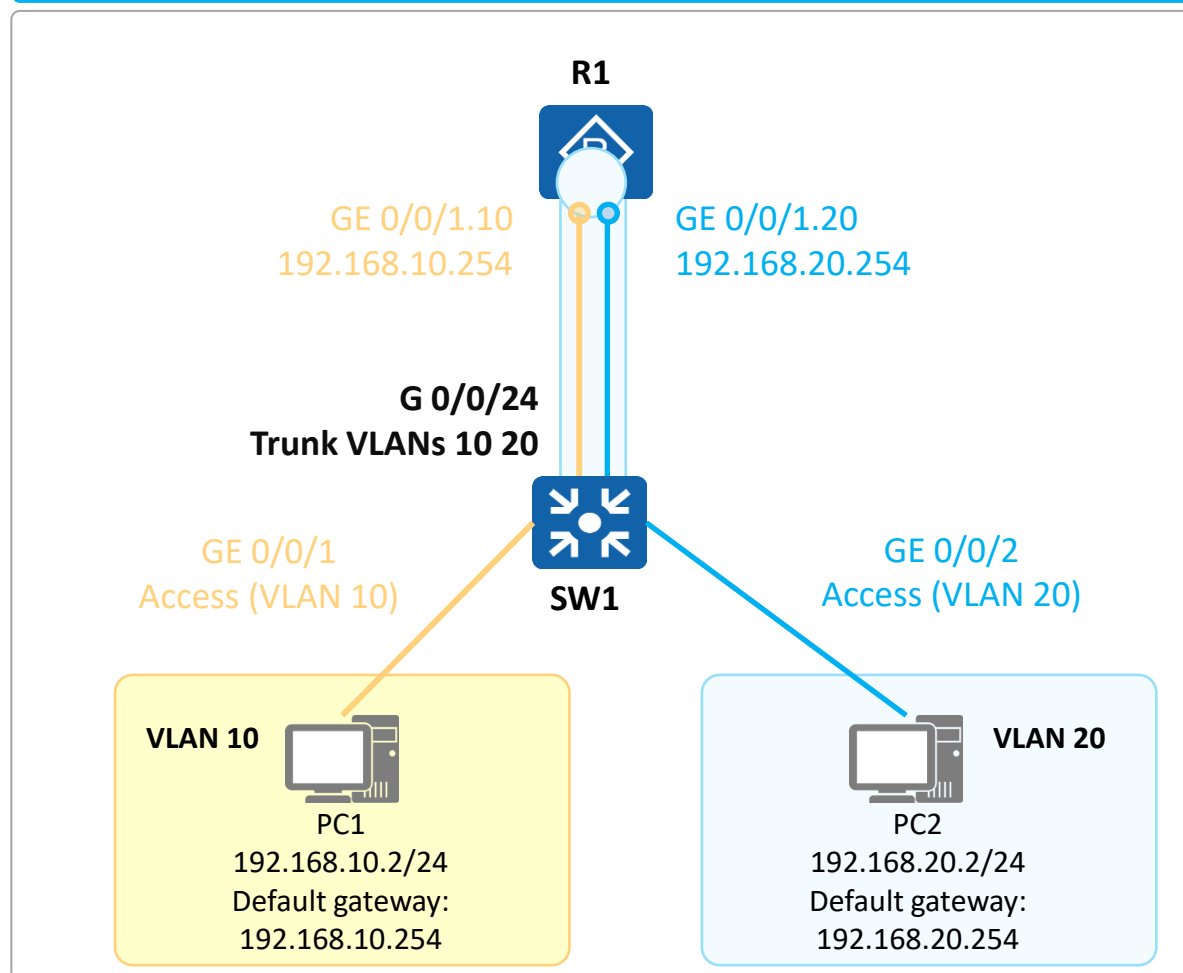


- The Layer 3 interfaces of the router function as gateways to forward traffic from the local network segment to other network segments.
- The Layer 3 interfaces of the router cannot process data frames with VLAN tags. Therefore, the interfaces of the switch connected to the router must be set to the access type.
- One physical interface of the router can function as the gateway of only one VLAN, meaning that the number of required physical interfaces are determined by the quantity of the deployed VLANs.
- A router, mainly forwarding packets at Layer 3, provides only a small number of physical interfaces. Therefore, the scalability of this solution is poor.



Using a Router's Sub-interfaces

Physical Connection

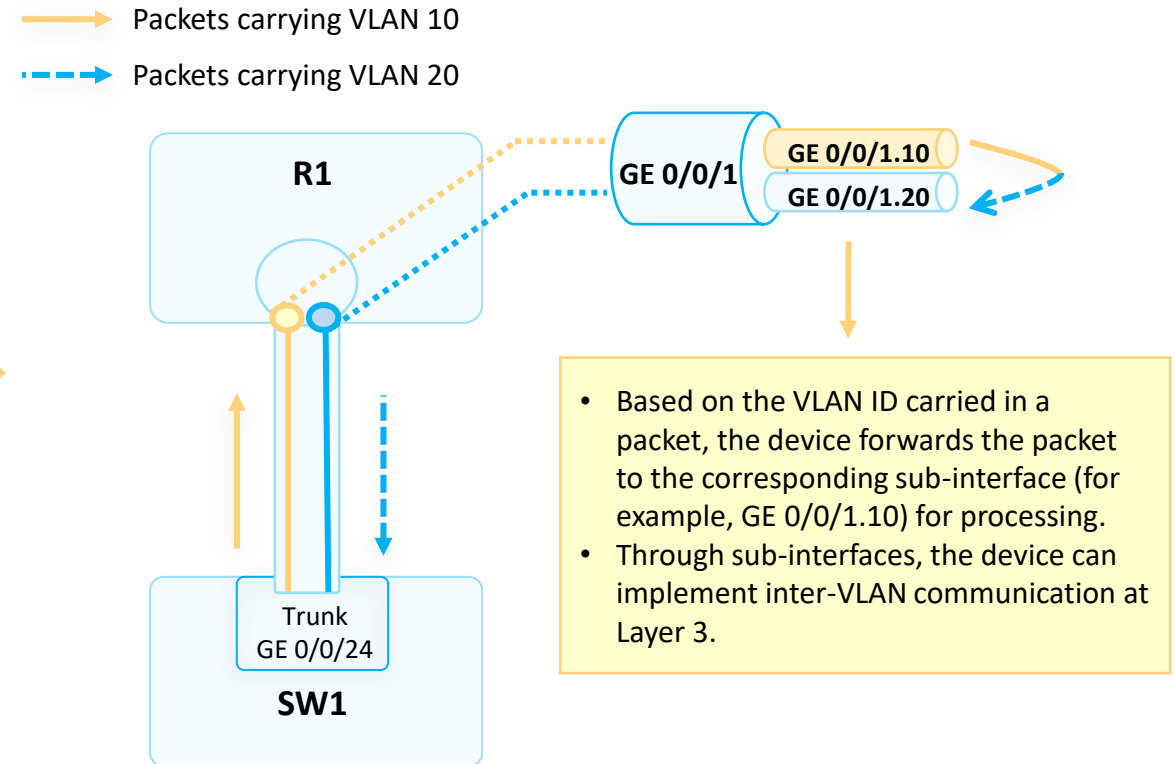
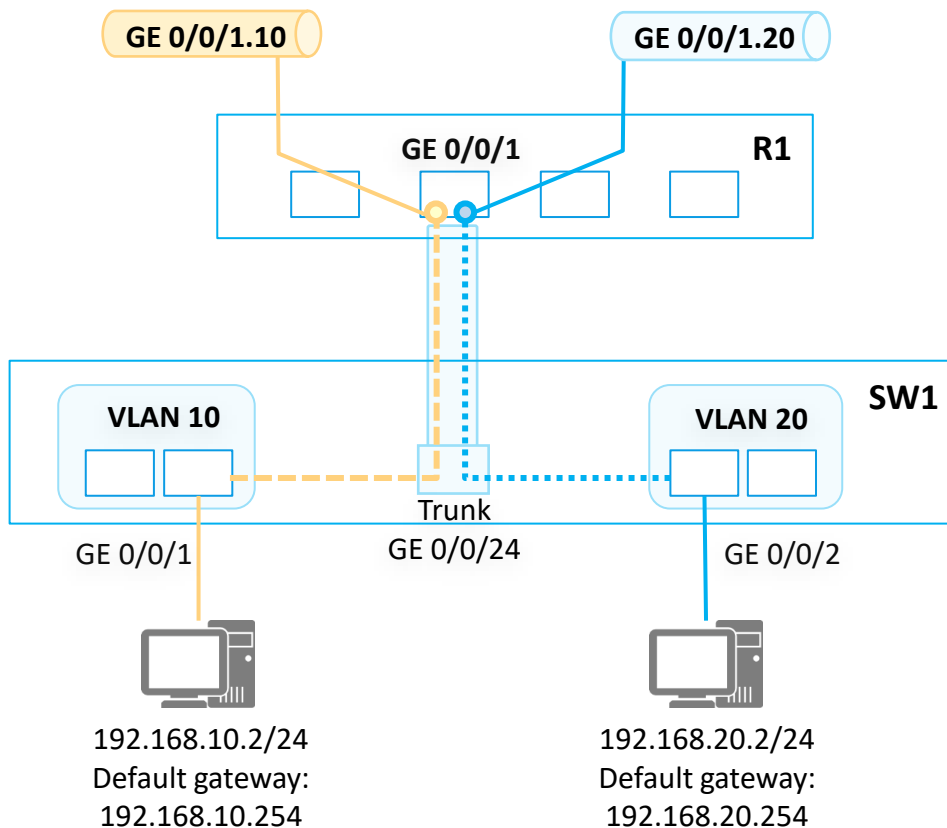


- A sub-interface is a logical interface created on a router's Ethernet interface and is identified by a physical interface number and a sub-interface number. Similar to a physical interface, a sub-interface can perform Layer 3 forwarding.
- Different from a physical interface, a sub-interface can terminate data frames with VLAN tags.
- You can create multiple sub-interfaces on one physical interface. After connecting the physical interface to the trunk interface of the switch, the physical interface can provide Layer 3 forwarding services for multiple VLANs.



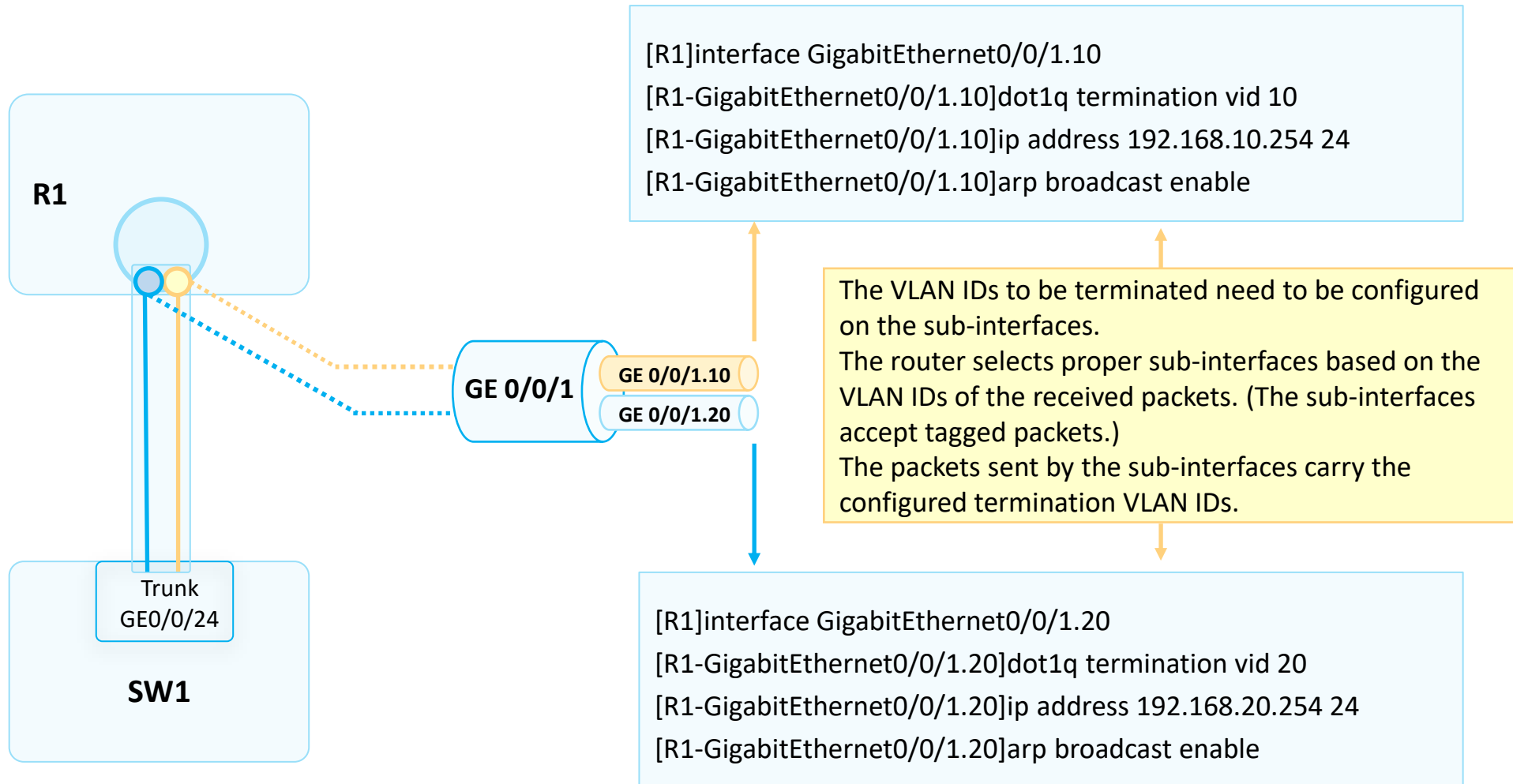
Sub-Interface Processing

- The interface connecting the switch to the router is set to a trunk interface. The router forwards the received packets to the corresponding sub-interfaces according to the VLAN tags in the packets.





Example for Configuring Sub-interfaces



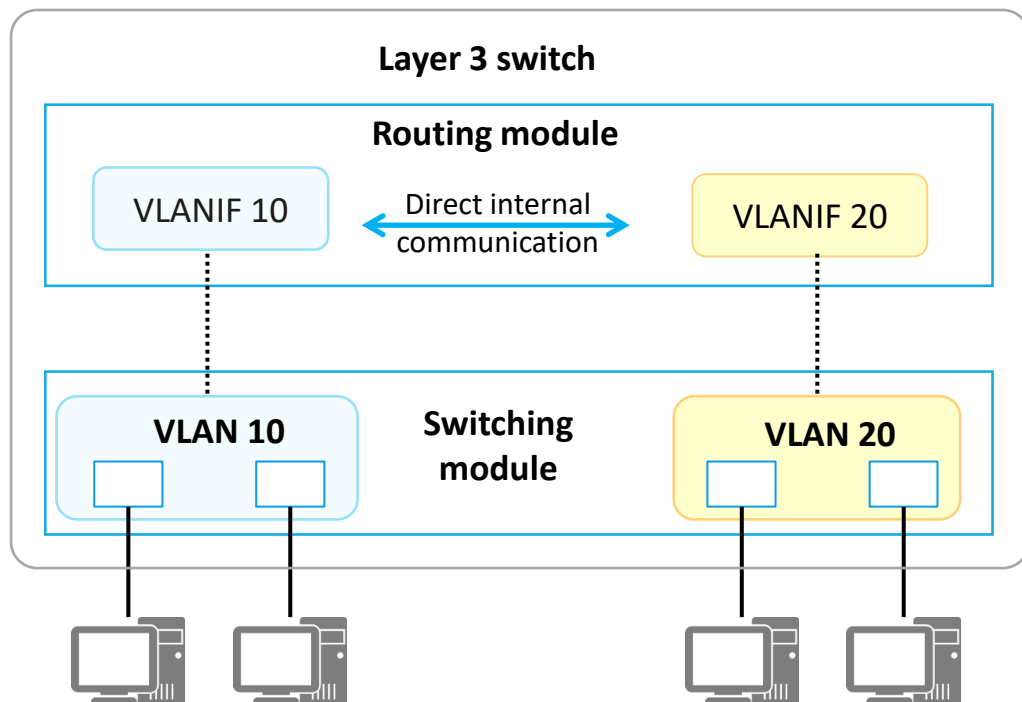


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Layer 3 Switch and VLANIF Interfaces

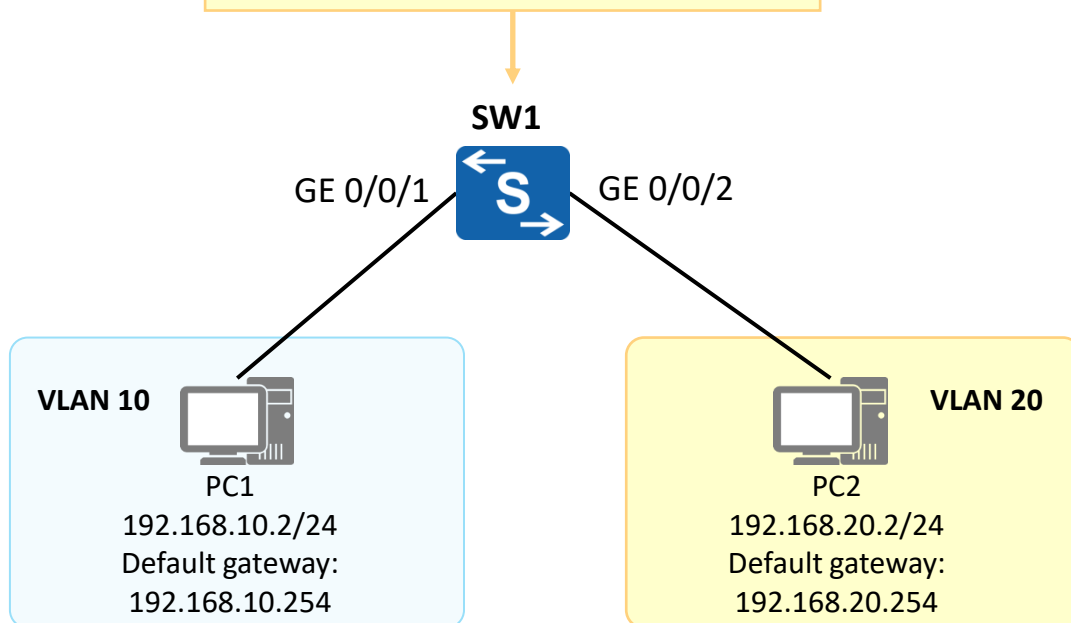


- A Layer 2 switch provides only Layer 2 switching functions.
- A Layer 3 switch provides routing functions through Layer 3 interfaces (such as VLANIF interfaces) as well as the functions of a Layer 2 switch.
- A VLANIF interface is a Layer 3 logical interface that can remove and add VLAN tags. VLANIF interfaces therefore can be used to implement inter-VLAN communication.
- A VLANIF interface number is the same as the ID of its corresponding VLAN. For example, VLANIF 10 is created based on VLAN 10.



Example for Configuring VLANIF Interfaces

- VLANIF 10 192.168.10.254/24
- VLANIF 20 192.168.20.254/24



- Configuration Requirements
Configure VLANs 10 and 20 for the interfaces connecting to PC1 and PC2, respectively. Configure the Layer 3 switch to allow the two PCs to communicate with each other.

Basic configurations:

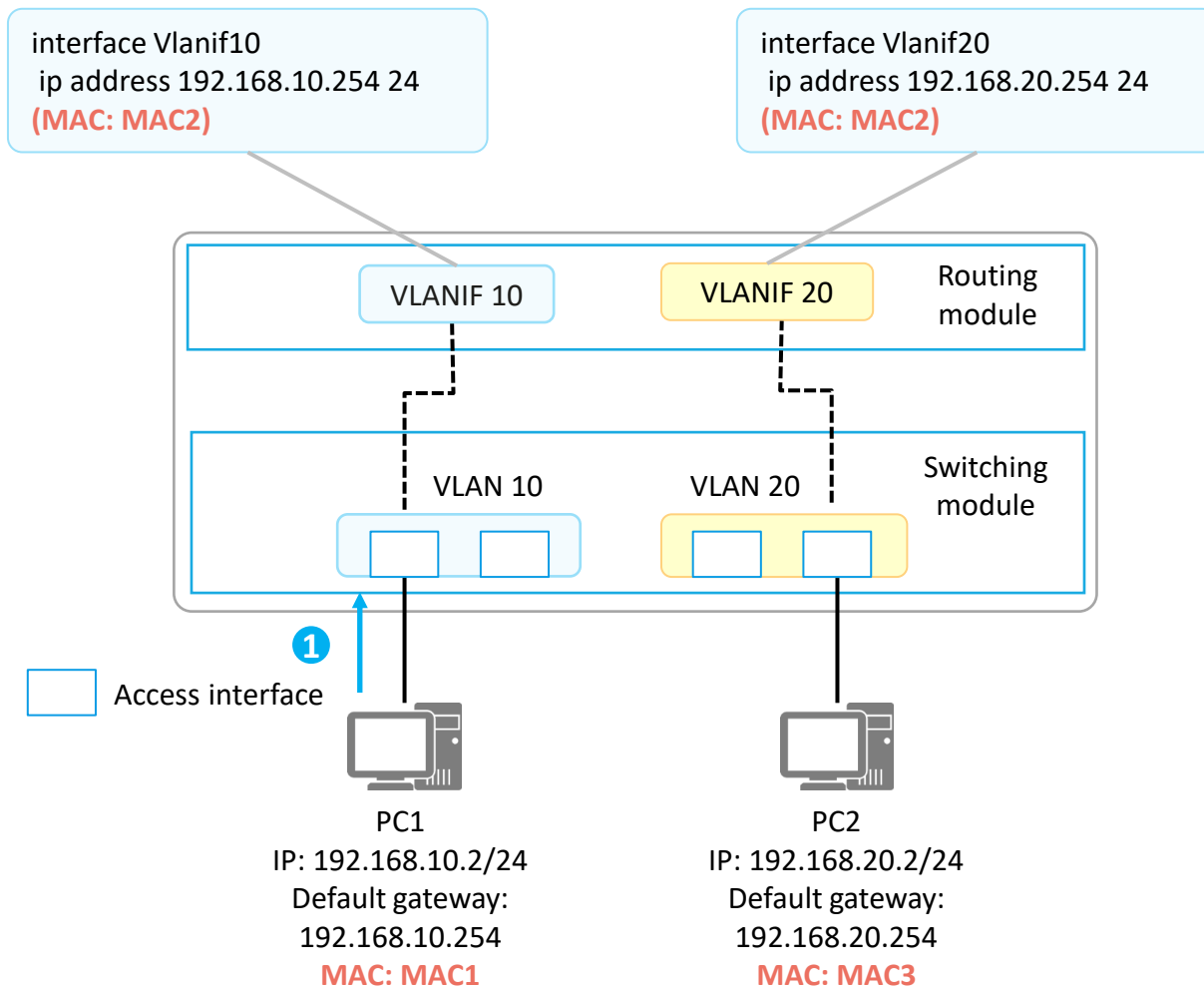
```
[SW1]vlan batch 10 20
[SW1] interface GigabitEthernet 0/0/1
[SW1-GigabitEthernet0/0/1] port link-type access
[SW1-GigabitEthernet0/0/1] port default vlan 10
[SW1] interface GigabitEthernet 0/0/2
[SW1-GigabitEthernet0/0/2] port link-type access
[SW1-GigabitEthernet0/0/2] port default vlan 20
```

Configure VLANIF interfaces:

```
[SW1]interface Vlanif 10
[SW1-Vlanif10]ip address 192.168.10.254 24
[SW1]interface Vlanif 20
[SW1-Vlanif20]ip address 192.168.20.254 24
```



VLANIF Forwarding Process (1)



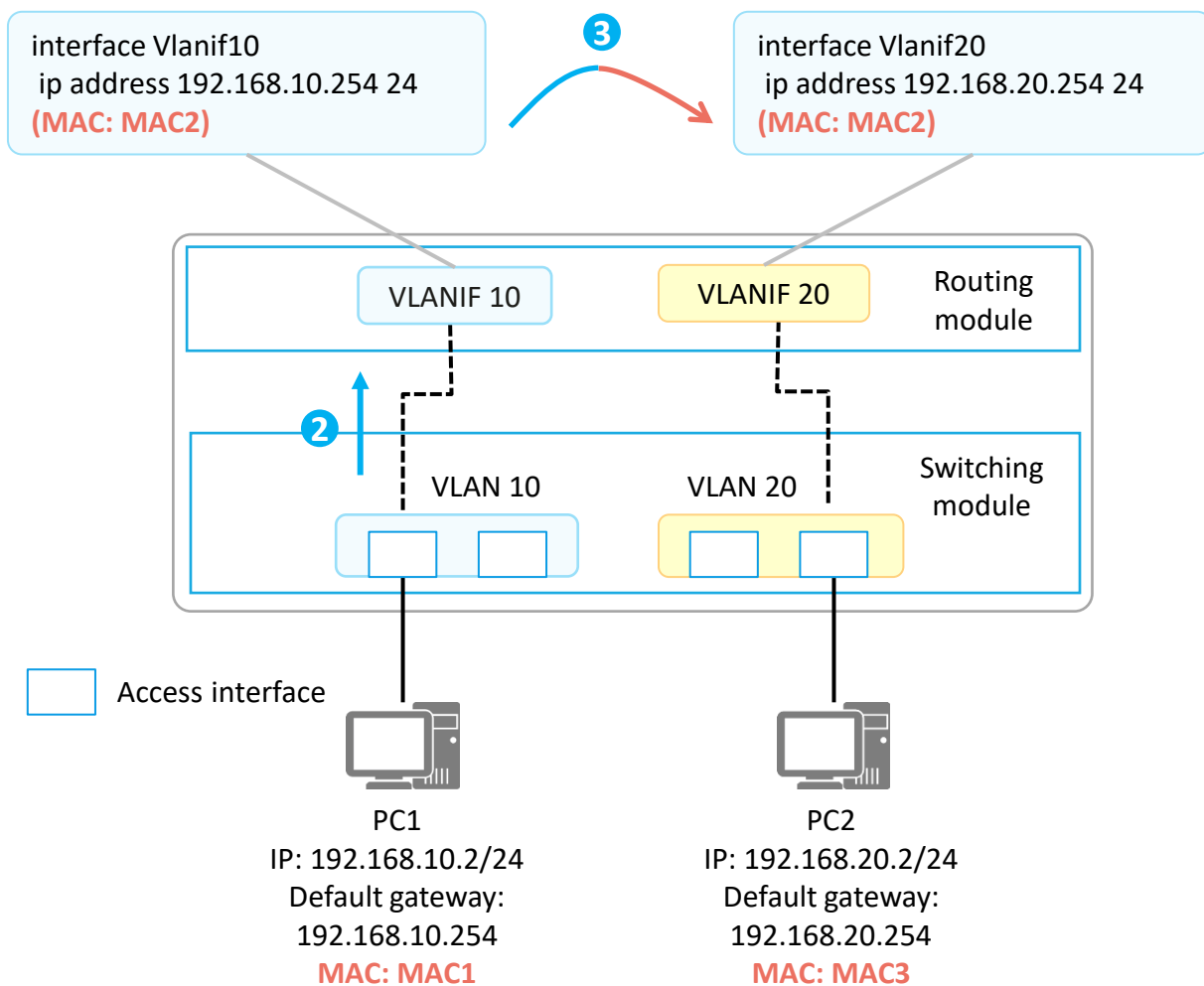
This example assumes that the required ARP or MAC address entries already exist on the PCs and the Layer 3 switch.

The communication process between PC1 and PC2 is as follows:

1. PC1 performs calculation based on its local IP address, local subnet mask, and destination IP address, and finds that the destination device PC2 is not on its network segment. PC1 then determines that Layer 3 communication is required and sends the traffic destined for PC2 to its gateway. Data frame sent by PC1: source MAC = MAC1, destination MAC = MAC2



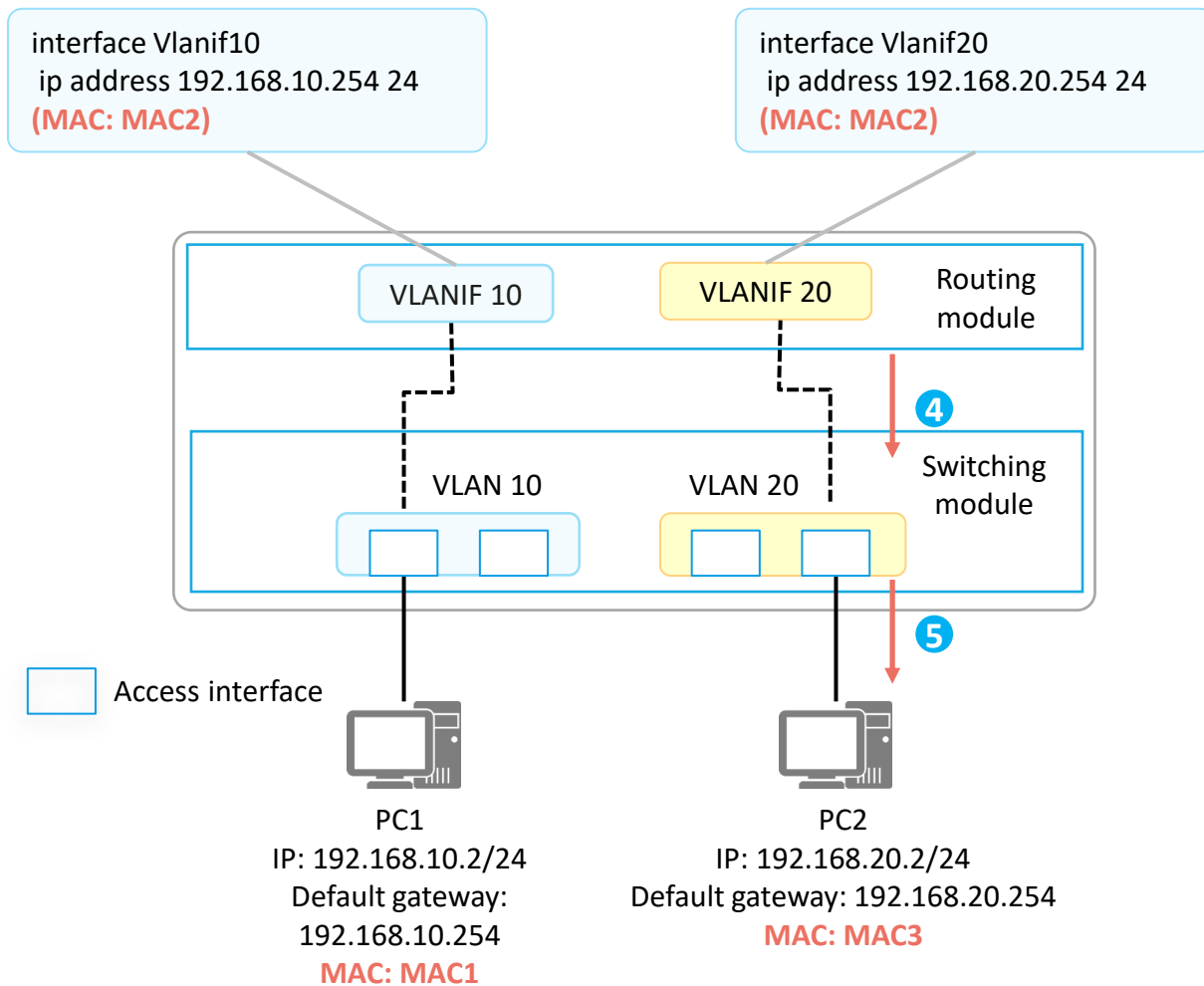
VLANIF Forwarding Process (2)



2. After receiving the packet sent from PC1 to PC2, the switch decapsulates the packet and finds that the destination MAC address is the MAC address of VLANIF 10. The switch then sends the packet to the routing module for further processing.
3. The routing module finds that the destination IP address is 192.168.20.2, which is not the IP address of its local interface, and determines that this packet needs to be forwarded at Layer 3. By searching the routing table, the routing module finds a matching route – the direct route generated by VLANIF 20 – for this packet.



VLANIF Forwarding Process (3)



4. Because the matching route is a direct route, the switch determines that the packet has reached the last hop. It searches its ARP table for 192.168.20.2, obtains the corresponding MAC address, and sends the packet to the switching module for re-encapsulation.
5. The switching module searches its MAC address table to determine the outbound interface of the frame and whether the frame needs to carry a VLAN tag. Data frame sent by the switching module: source MAC = MAC2, destination MAC = MAC3, VLAN tag = None

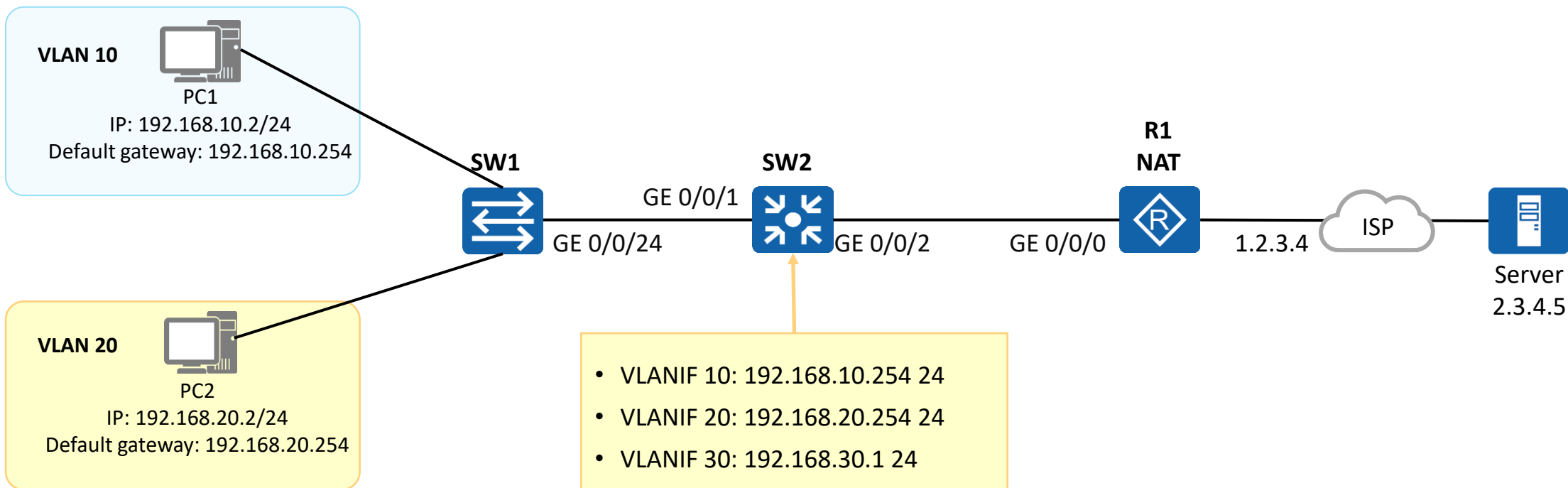


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Network Topology

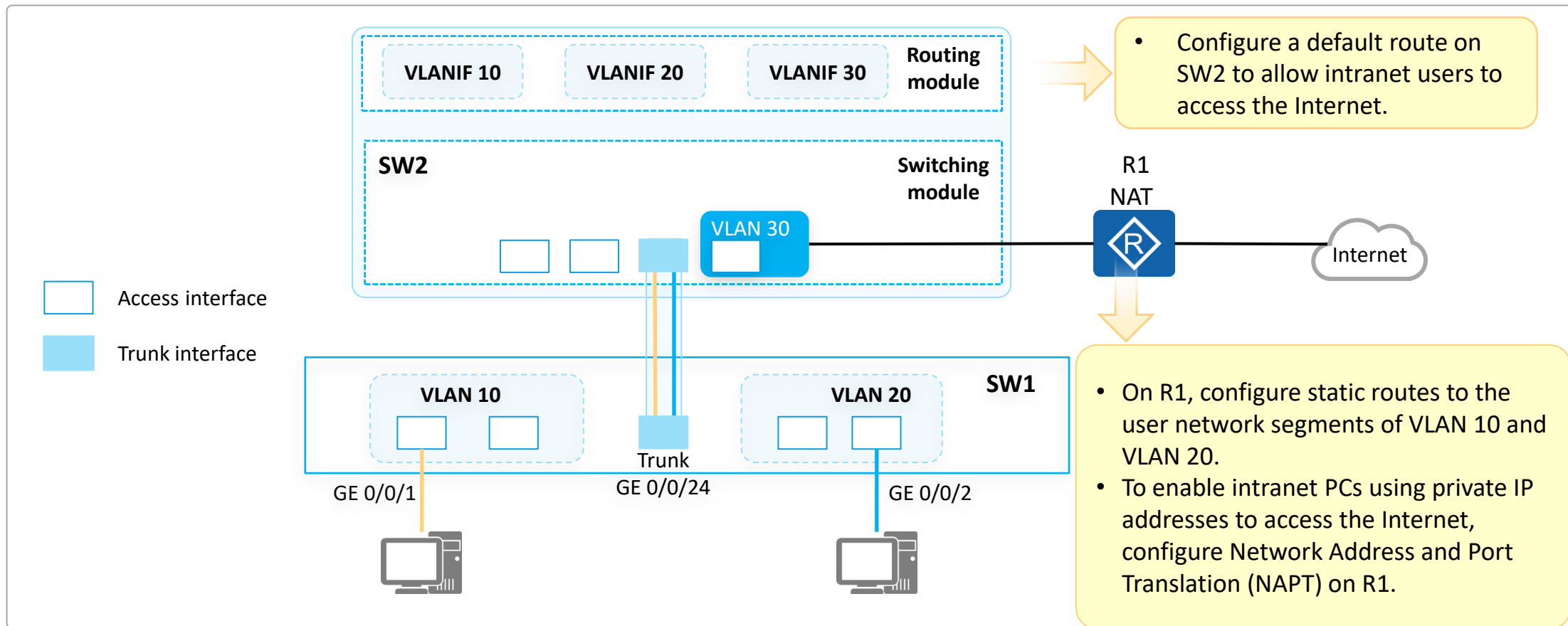


This topology is used as an example to describe the communication process from PC1 in VLAN 10 to the server (2.3.4.5) on the Internet.



Logical Connection

Logical Connection



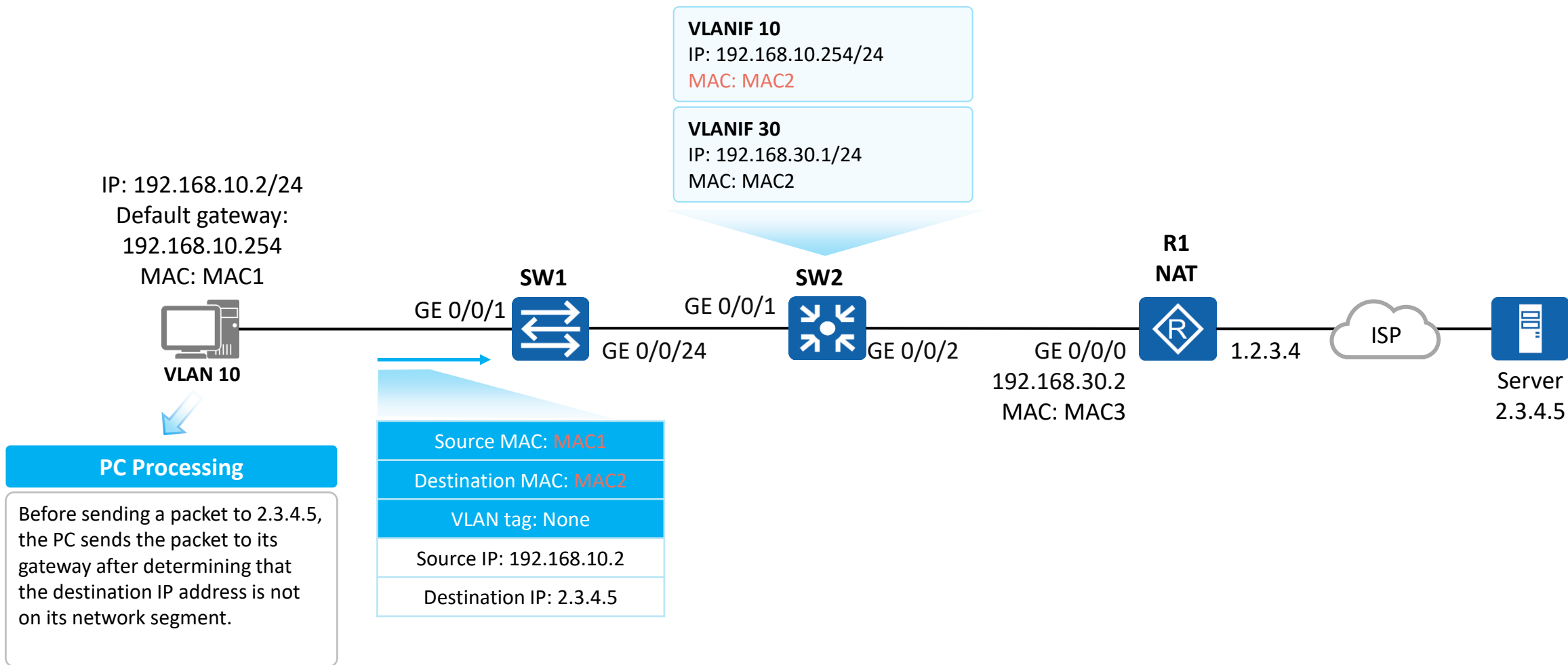


Communication Process (1)

Network
Topology

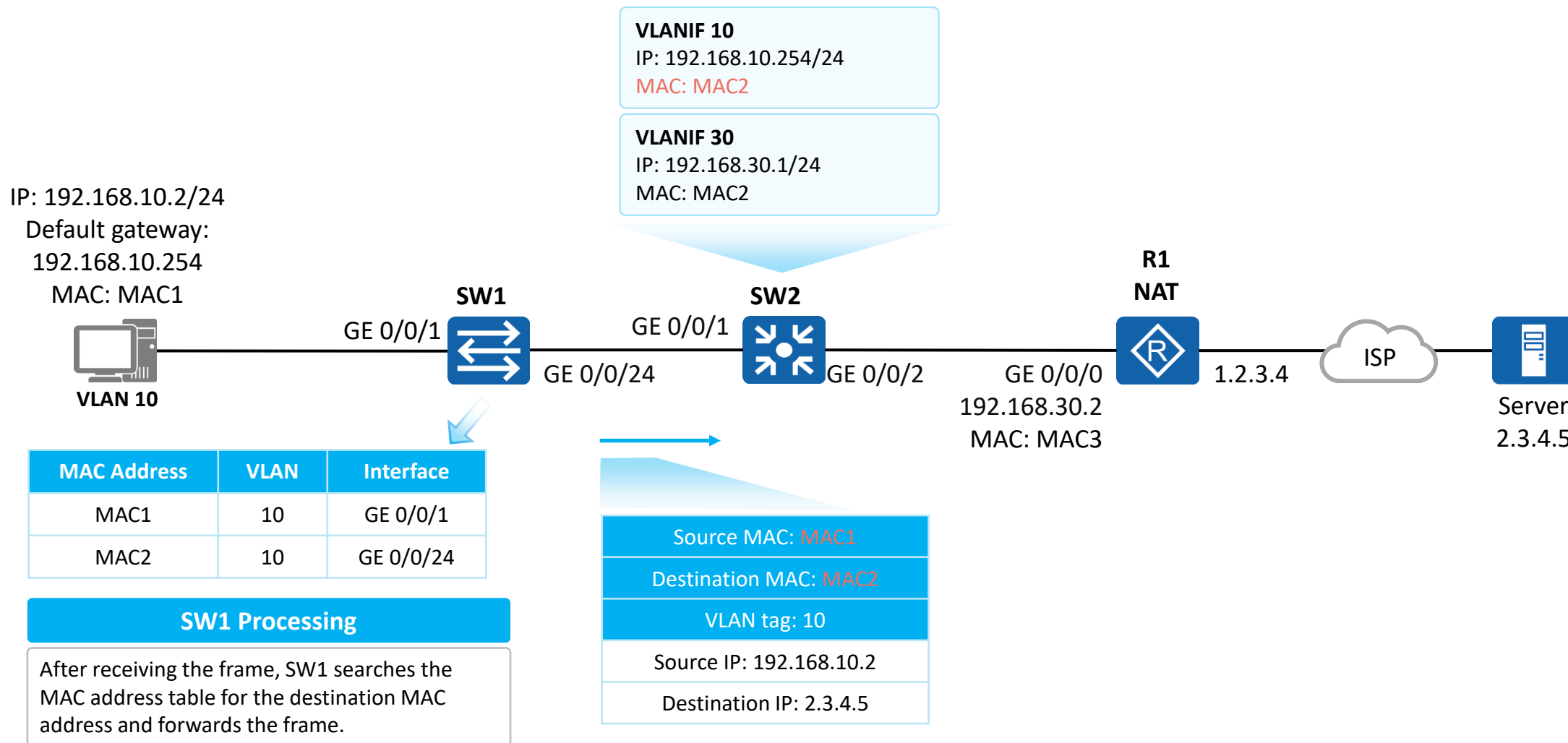
Logical
Connection

Communication
Process



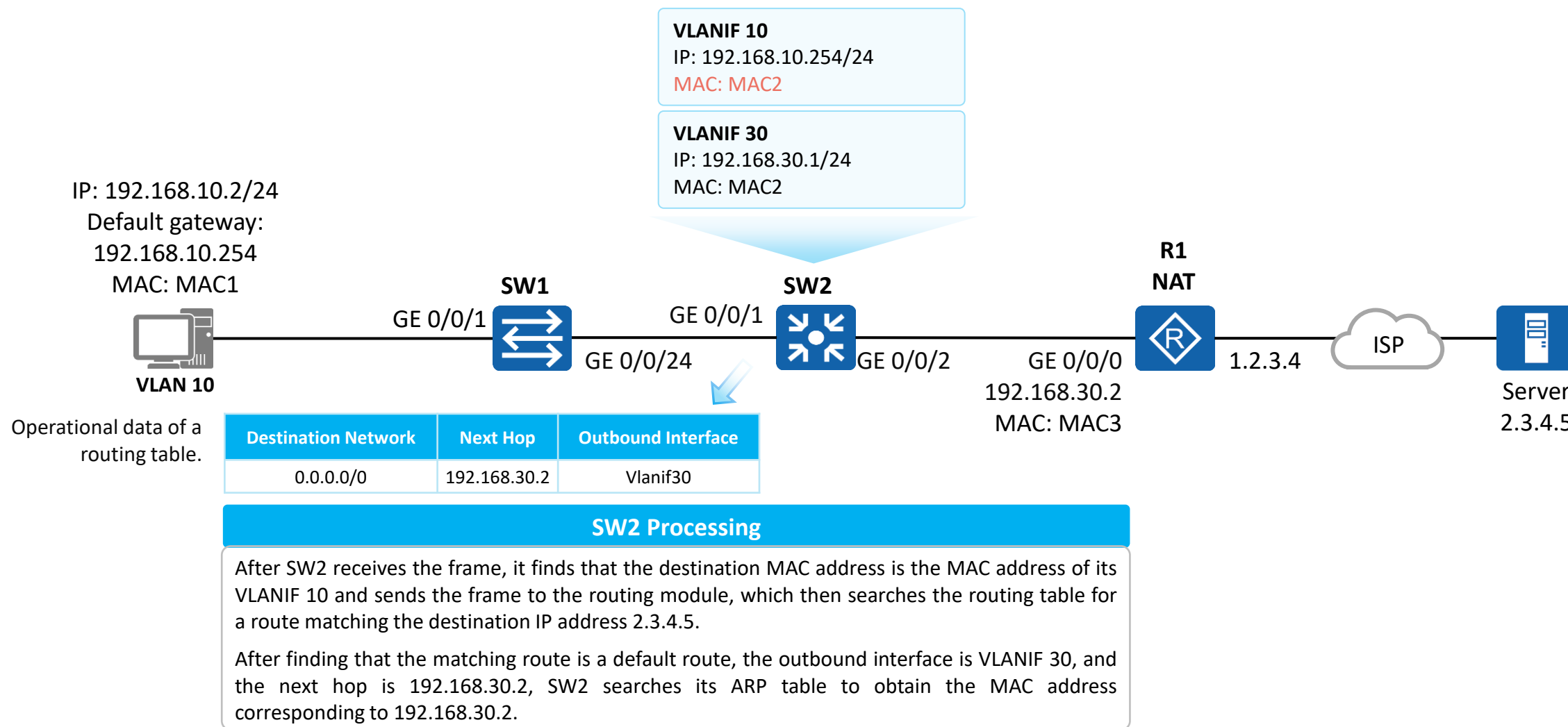


Communication Process (2)



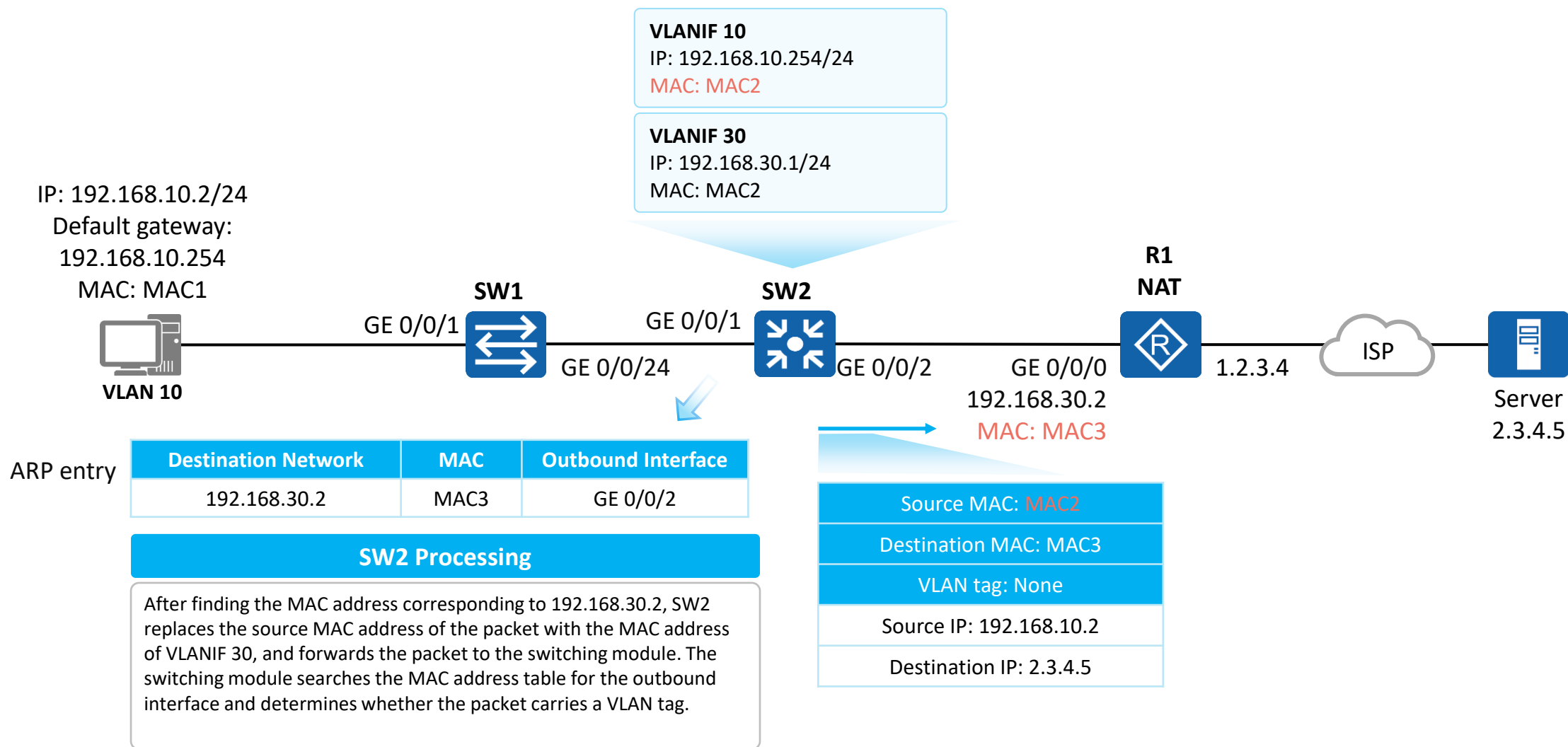


Communication Process (3)



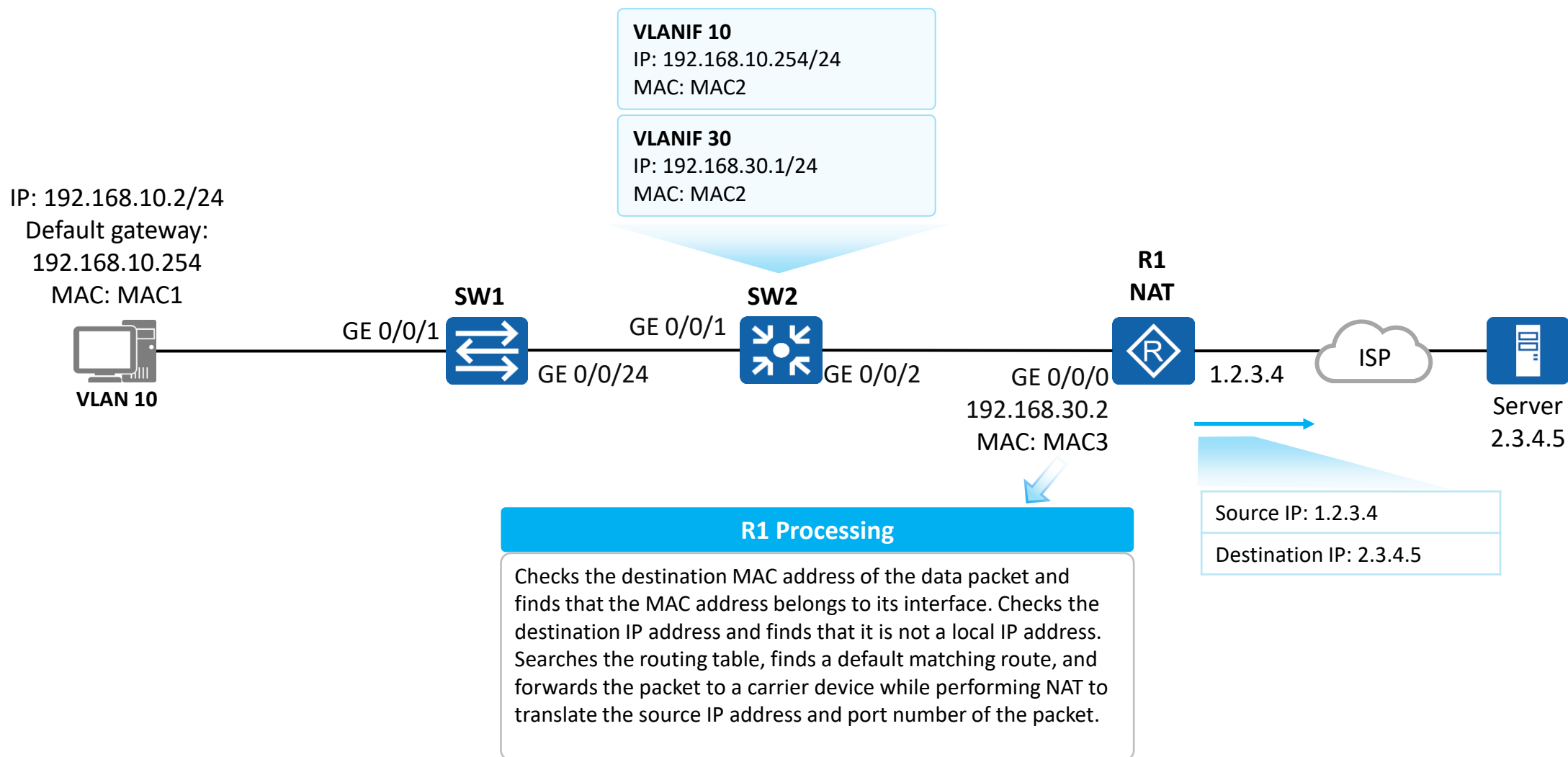


Communication Process (4)





Communication Process (5)





Quiz

1. When a sub-interface is used to implement inter-VLAN communication, how does the switch interface connected to the router need to be configured?
2. How are packets changed when being forwarded at Layer 3?



Summary

- This course describes three methods of implementing inter-VLAN communication: through physical interfaces, sub-interfaces, and VLANIF interfaces.
- It also elaborates the Layer 3 communication process, and device processing mechanism and packet header changes during the communication.



More Information

- Comparison between Layer 2 and Layer 3 interfaces

Layer 2 Interface	Layer 3 Interface
An IP address cannot be configured for a Layer 2 interface.	An IP address can be configured for a Layer 3 interface
A Layer 2 interface does not have a MAC address.	A Layer 3 interface has a MAC address.
After a Layer 2 interface receives a data frame, it searches its MAC address table for the destination MAC address of the frame. If a matching MAC address entry is found, it forwards the frame according to the entry. If no matching MAC address entry is found, it floods the frame.	After a Layer 3 interface receives a data frame, if the destination MAC address of the data frame is the same as the local MAC address, it decapsulates the data frame and looks up the destination IP address of the data packet in the routing table. If a matching route is found, it forwards the data frame according to the instruction of the route. If no matching route is found, it discards the packet.
A physical interface on a Layer 2 switch (has only Layer 2 switching capabilities) is a typical Layer 2 interface. By default, the physical interfaces of most Layer 3 switches (have both Layer 2 and Layer 3 switching capabilities) work at Layer 2.	A Layer 3 interface on a router is a typical Layer 3 interface. Physical interfaces on some Layer 3 switches can be switched to Layer 3 mode. In addition to Layer 3 physical interfaces, there are Layer 3 logical interfaces, such as VLANIF interfaces on switches or logical sub-interfaces on other network devices, such as GE 0/0/1.10.
Layer 2 interfaces do not isolate broadcast domains. They flood received broadcast frames.	Layer 3 interfaces isolate broadcast domains. They directly terminate received broadcast frames instead of flooding them.

The background of the slide features a blue-tinted image of several business professionals in a modern office. They are standing on a highly reflective floor, and their silhouettes are clearly visible. In the background, a city skyline with tall buildings is visible through large windows. The overall atmosphere is professional and corporate.

Thank You
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